



Cabinet

Title: Public Mental Health Action Plan

Paper No. 26-16

Date: 26 January 2026

Cabinet Member for: Health

Details of Executive Director: Jeremy DeSouza, Executive Director of Adult Social Care and Public Health

1. **Executive Summary**

- 1.1. Mental health is a priority in Wandsworth Council's Corporate Plan. This report introduces the final version of 'Healthy Minds' Public Mental Health Action Plan, informed by the 2022 Mental Health Needs Assessment¹. The plan outlines Council-led programmes requiring long-term delivery to improve population mental health and prevent mental-ill health which aligns with the Council's vision for a fair, compassionate, and sustainable borough. It was discussed at the Health Committee on 18 November 2025 as requested by Cllr. Dobres. The Executive Director of Finance comments that there are no financial implications arising from this report currently.

¹ [Mental Health Needs Assessment - Wandsworth Borough Council](#)

2. Recommendation:

- 2.1. Approve a five-year cross-council Public Mental Health Action Plan for the London Borough of Wandsworth.

3. Details

- 3.1. This report presents the Council's 'Healthy Minds' Public Mental Health Action Plan, a prevention-focused initiative designed to improve the mental health and wellbeing of Wandsworth residents. Rooted in the Council's Prevention Framework, the plan promotes collaborative working across council departments, NHS partners, and the voluntary and community sector. It focuses on the social and environmental factors that shape mental health, recognising the Council's significant influence through leadership on the building blocks of health. Organised around four thematic areas: Growth and Success, Healthy Living, Community and Environment, and Foundations for wellbeing, the plan highlights the pivotal role of Council-led policies in areas such as housing, education, public health, welfare, leisure, and social care in improving population mental health.
- 3.2. The Public Mental Health Action Plan provides a strategic framework for a coordinated cross-council approach to improving population mental health. This ambitious initiative is fully aligned with the values of the Better Services Partnership, which include thinking bigger, putting people first, fostering connections, leading by example, and embracing difference. The plan introduces a matrix model that connects a diverse range of programmes addressing the building blocks of health. This is informed by local and national level insights from the 2022 Mental Health Needs Assessment¹. It highlights the essential preventative role of local authorities and clearly defines the Council's contribution within the broader context of Integrated Care Partnerships. In addition, it complements the mental health strategies of the Integrated Care Board and the local mental health trust, thereby reinforcing a whole-system approach to mental health and wellbeing.
- 3.3. The Public Mental Health Action Plan was well received at the Health Overview and Scrutiny Committee on 18 November 2025. Minor amendments were made to support Councillors' suggestions and reflective of the final public consultation that closed on 18 December 2025. Clarifying language and additional diagram labels were added following consultation with the Youth Council.
- 3.4. The next steps are outlined in the first-year action plan, including development of a quarterly 'Healthy Minds Steering Group' to govern the

progress and reporting of outcomes. There will be a launch event in March 2026 to showcase The Public Mental Health Action Plan and discuss partner priorities to inform the second-year action plan.

4. **Financial Implications**

- 4.1. There are no financial implications arising from this report.

5. **Legal Implications**

- 5.1. There are no legal implications arising from this report.

6. **Equalities Implications**

- 6.1. The Equality Act 2010 requires that the Council when exercising its functions must have "due regard" to the need to eliminate discrimination, to advance equality of opportunity between persons who share a relevant protected characteristic and persons who do not share it and to foster good relations between persons who share a relevant protected characteristic and persons who do not share it. As such an Equality Impact Needs Analysis (EINA) has been undertaken on the Public Mental Health Action Plan.

- 6.2. This EINA has found increased prevalence, complexity, acuity, and longevity of mental health conditions. This is especially true considering the pandemic, the cost-of-living crisis, and accelerating climate change, all compounded by an increasingly volatile geopolitical landscape and limited resources for public services, which have further eroded the resilience of individuals and the systems that support them. Rising demands on mental health services are leading to increased wait times and insufficient care. The EINA also identified mental health disorders are more common in people living alone, in poor physical health or with a disability or who are unemployed. Service users with neurodiversity and/or learning disabilities, those with co-occurring mental health and substance misuse disorders, carers and Global Majority groups are particularly vulnerable.

7. **Supporting the Wandsworth Environment and Sustainability Strategy (WESS)**

- 7.1. The Public Mental Health Action Plan aligns with the ambitions of the Wandsworth Environment and Sustainability Strategy, identifying environmental improvement programmes as a key priority. By fostering a cleaner, greener, healthier, and safer borough, these efforts aim to enhance the mental health and wellbeing of residents.

8. **Conclusion**

- 8.1. The Public Mental Health Action Plan sets out a strategic, prevention-focused framework for improving population mental health in Wandsworth. Grounded in the Council's Prevention Framework and shaped through cross-directorate collaboration, the plan highlights the Council's leadership role in addressing the building blocks of mental health. Cabinet is recommended to approve The Public Mental Health Action Plan to guide and champion the Council's ongoing approach to improving mental health in Wandsworth.

Reference to any accompanying papers:

Appendix 1: 'Healthy Minds' Public Mental Health Action Plan

